

UNOFFICIAL PLAYER'S COMPANION

Don't Miss a Thing

Missables · Endings · Gwent

The interactive checklist for The Witcher 3 Remastered — every point of no return, Ciri's five choices, every kingdom's fate and the Gwent cards you can lose forever.

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BEFORE YOU RIDE OUT

How to use this guide

The Witcher 3 is generous — until it isn't. A handful of story moments quietly close whole questlines, lock endings and remove Gwent cards for good. This guide shows you exactly where those moments are, so you can explore freely and never lose 100 hours of choices to one boat ride.

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THE GOLDEN RULE

When the game offers you a boat to the **Isle of Mists**, stop. Make a separate save, open page 5, and tick every box first.

SPOILER LEVEL

Pages 3–6 and 9–11 are light on spoilers. Pages 7–8 talk about endings — read them when you reach Kaer Morhen, or before your first run if you don't mind.

INTERACTIVE CHECKLIST

Tap any box to tick it — works in Adobe Acrobat Reader, Chrome, Edge and most phone PDF apps. Save the file to keep your progress. Prefer paper? Just print it.

CHAPTER I

The Three Points of No Return

Almost everything in the game waits for you. These moments do not.

#	MOMENT	WHAT IT CLOSES
1	**Leaving White Orchard** Riding with the Nilfgaardian escort to the Emperor	Every open White Orchard side quest, contract and Gwent game. Only ***Faithful Friend*** can still be finished later.
2	**Sailing to the Isle of Mists** Main quest ***The Isle of Mists***	The biggest cutoff in the game. Around **19 side quests** auto-fail, including Keira Metz's whole arc, the Triss romance, the Radovid assassination chain and your last chance to recruit allies for Kaer Morhen.
3	**DLC one-way doors** Hearts of Stone heist · Blood and Wine fairy-tale land	Finishing the heist closes side content tied to the auction house. The Land of a Thousand Fables is visited only once — explore it fully before you leave.

> ALSO WATCH OUT FOR
>
> Characters who die or leave during the story take their **Gwent cards** and **merchant stock** with them. Buy out Gwent cards from Velen and Novigrad merchants early — some become unreachable as the story advances.

Save habits that save runs

- [ ] Hard save before every main quest marked with a boat, a portal or a "this will take you away" warning.
- [ ] Keep one save per region: *White Orchard · Velen · Novigrad · Skellige · Kaer Morhen*.
- [ ] Before the Isle of Mists, name a save **"BEFORE MISTS"** — you'll thank yourself.

CHAPTER II · POINT OF NO RETURN #1

White Orchard Checklist

The tutorial region is small, but everything here closes when you ride out to meet the Emperor.

Side quests & contracts

- [ ] Missing in Action
- [ ] On Death's Bed
- [ ] Precious Cargo
- [ ] A Frying Pan, Spick and Span
- [ ] Twisted Firestarter
- [ ] Contract: Devil by the Well

Before you leave

- [ ] Play the innkeeper at Gwent and buy the cards on offer.
- [ ] Read every notice board in the village.
- [ ] Clear the "?" markers — easy early loot and XP.
- [ ] Unlock every signpost (fast travel).
- [ ] Visit the Places of Power you find — free skill points.
- [ ] Check your inventory: sell junk, keep crafting diagrams.

RELAX

Faithful Friend is the one White Orchard quest that stays available after you leave.

CHAPTER III · POINT OF NO RETURN #2

The Big One — Before the Isle of Mists

*Finish these before you board the boat in the main quest **The Isle of Mists**. Anything unfinished here fails automatically.*

Keira Metz (Velen)

- [ ] Magic Lamp
- [ ] A Towerful of Mice
- [ ] A Favor for a Friend
- [ ] For the Advancement of Learning
  Send her to **Kaer Morhen** at the end to recruit her.

Triss & Novigrad

- [ ] A Matter of Life and Death
  Includes a small Gwent tournament — win every round for its cards.
- [ ] Now or Never
  Your choices here decide the Triss romance and whether Radovid can later be stopped.
- [ ] Pyres of Novigrad
  Finish the whole chain to spare Novigrad's mages and non-humans.
- [ ] Carnal Sins
  The Novigrad murder mystery.

Roche, Dijkstra & Radovid

- [ ] An Eye for an Eye
  Needed for Roche & Ves to join you at Kaer Morhen.
- [ ] The Radovid chain
  It opens through Triss's ***Now or Never***. Skip it and ***Reason of State*** is locked forever.

Skellige's throne

- [ ] Possession
- [ ] The Lord of Undvik
- [ ] King's Gambit
  Picks Skellige's ruler and recruits Hjalmar.

Allies

- [ ] Brothers in Arms: Velen
- [ ] Brothers in Arms: Novigrad
- [ ] Brothers in Arms: Skellige

CHAPTER IV

Allies for the Battle of Kaer Morhen

*The more friends you bring, the better the battle goes. Recruiting all of them below (except the bonus) unlocks the **Full Crew** achievement / trophy.*

	ALLY	HOW TO RECRUIT
☐	**Keira Metz**	Complete all her side quests. In the last one, ***For the Advancement of Learning***, send her to Kaer Morhen.
☐	**Triss**	Joins as part of the story when you gather allies.
☐	**Roche & Ves**	Complete ***An Eye for an Eye***, then talk to Roche during ***Brothers in Arms: Novigrad***.
☐	**Zoltan**	Talk to him during ***Brothers in Arms: Novigrad***.
☐	**Ermion**	Talk to him during ***Brothers in Arms: Skellige***.
☐	**Hjalmar**	Complete Skellige's succession: ***Possession***, ***The Lord of Undvik***, ***King's Gambit***.
☐	**Letho** BONUS	Only if you told Voorhis at the start of the game that Letho is alive. Complete ***The Fall of House Reardon*** and ***Ghosts of the Past***, then send him to Kaer Morhen. Not needed for Full Crew.

> **REMEMBER**
>
> Every one of these must be done **before the Isle of Mists**. After that boat, the invitation list is closed.

CHAPTER V · SPOILERS

Ciri's Fate — The Five Moments

The game quietly scores how you treat Ciri in five moments across three late quests. The tally, plus one political condition, decides her ending.

	QUEST	POSITIVE CHOICE
☐	***Blood on the Battlefield***	Cheer her up with the **snowball fight** (***"I know what might lift your spirits"***).
☐	***Blood on the Battlefield*** **only if you visit Emhyr**	**Refuse the Emperor's payment.** Accepting it counts against you.
☐	***Final Preparations***	Let Ciri **speak to the Lodge of Sorceresses alone**.
☐	***Child of the Elder Blood***	When she loses her temper in Avallac'h's laboratory, say ***"Go for it."***
☐	***Child of the Elder Blood***	Go with her to **Skjall's grave** (***"Yeah, I'll go with you."***).

The three endings

WITCHER CIRI

At least **3 positive** moments, and **don't take Ciri to see Emhyr**. The most popular "best" ending.

EMPRESS CIRI

At least **3 positive** moments, **take her to Emhyr**, and make sure **Nilfgaard wins the war** (page 8 — Roche's side of ***Reason of State***).

THE BAD ENDING

Fewer than 3 positive moments leads to the saddest ending. Accepting Emhyr's coin is the most common way players lose a point without noticing.

TIP

If you skip the Emhyr visit, only four moments are scored — so three of four must be positive.

CHAPTER VI · SPOILERS

The Fate of Kingdoms

The epilogue slides show what became of the North and the Isles. Here's what decides them.

The North: Redania, Nilfgaard & Temeria

	OUTCOME	HOW
☐	**Radovid rules, Nilfgaard loses**	Ignore Triss's ***Now or Never***, so ***Reason of State*** never happens.
☐	**Dijkstra rules Redania**	Help kill Radovid in ***Reason of State***, then **don't interfere** when Dijkstra turns on Roche, Ves and Thaler.
☐	**Nilfgaard wins, Temeria restored**	Help kill Radovid, then **side with Roche and kill Dijkstra**. Temeria becomes a vassal state. Required for the Empress ending.

Skellige

	RULER	HOW
☐	**Cerys an Craite**	Complete ***King's Gambit*** and **side with Cerys**. Peace and prosperity for the Isles.
☐	**Hjalmar an Craite**	Complete ***King's Gambit*** and **side with Hjalmar**. The raids on the mainland continue.
☐	**Svanrige (default)**	Ignore the succession quests entirely.

> **PLAN YOUR WHOLE RUN IN ONE LINE**
>
> Want Empress Ciri? You need **Now or Never → Reason of State (kill Radovid) → side with Roche** plus the Emhyr visit and 3 good moments with Ciri. Want Witcher Ciri? Skip Emhyr, keep 3 good moments — politics are free.

CHAPTER VII

Gwent — Cards You Can Lose Forever

*The quest **Collect 'Em All** asks for 120 unique cards, and the game never tells you which ones you're missing. Protect these.*

Card rules of thumb

- [ ] Play every named Gwent player the moment you meet them.
  Characters can die or leave during quests — their unique card goes with them.
- [ ] Buy out merchant decks in Velen and Novigrad early.
  Some traders become unreachable as the story moves on.
- [ ] Play the innkeepers in every region.
- [ ] Finish all Gwent side quests before the Isle of Mists.

Known card traps

- [ ] A Matter of Life and Death
  Contains a small Gwent tournament — you must win every round to get all the cards.
- [ ] Now or Never
  A choice here can get a card-holder killed.
- [ ] Iorveth hero card
  Tied to a Velen side quest line — finish your Velen questlines before leaving the region for good.
- [ ] Quest-giver cards
  The Bloody Baron, Lambert and other story characters carry cards — win them while they're around.

Gwent tracker

	REGION	OPPONENTS BEATEN	MERCHANTS BOUGHT OUT
☐	White Orchard		
☐	Velen		
☐	Novigrad & Oxenfurt		
☐	Skellige		
☐	Kaer Morhen		

CHAPTER VIII · POINT OF NO RETURN #3

Hearts of Stone & Blood and Wine

Both expansions have their own one-way doors. They're easy to miss because the game doesn't warn you.

Hearts of Stone

- [ ] Finish the auction-house side quests **before** completing the heist in ***Open Sesame!***
  Finishing the heist closes side content tied to the auction house and its contacts.
- [ ] Collect your runewright upgrades as you go.
- [ ] Play Gwent with every new opponent around Oxenfurt.
- [ ] Make a save before the final choice with Gaunter O'Dimm.

Blood and Wine

- [ ] Explore the **Land of a Thousand Fables** completely.
  You only visit it once — finish its side errand and pick up everything before the story pulls you back out.
- [ ] Upgrade Corvo Bianco, your vineyard — it pays for itself.
- [ ] Collect the Grandmaster witcher gear diagrams.
- [ ] Save before the final act — your choices decide the ending in Toussaint.

WHEN TO START THE DLCS

Hearts of Stone is built for a level 30+ Geralt; Blood and Wine for level 34+. Most players do them after the main story's epilogue — the game lets you keep playing after the credits.

CHAPTER IX

New in Remastered

The September 2026 Remastered update is free for existing owners on PC, PS5, Xbox Series X|S and Switch 2. Stories, quests and endings are the same, so every checklist in this guide still applies.

SKILL TREE REWORK

Skills now sit in a tree with three ranks each, and some need prerequisites before they unlock. **Old build guides are out of date** — respec and experiment.

REFORGING

Change how your gear *looks* without changing its stats. Visit the master craftsmen **Yoana** or **Hattori**.

ALSO NEW

Upgraded textures, lighting and animations, improved combat, an expanded Photo Mode, new accessibility options and cross-platform mod support.

Recommended Order

	#	WHERE	BEFORE MOVING ON
☐	1	**White Orchard**	Page 4 checklist
☐	2	**Velen**	Keira's quests, the Bloody Baron, Velen Gwent
☐	3	**Novigrad**	Triss, Roche, Carnal Sins, Pyres of Novigrad
☐	4	**Skellige**	The succession quests
☐	5	**Isle of Mists**	Everything on pages 5–6 ticked
☐	6	**Kaer Morhen & final acts**	Page 7 — Ciri's five moments
☐	7	**Hearts of Stone**	Page 10
☐	8	**Blood and Wine**	Page 10

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